

GENERAL PROBLEM: On interpersonal relationship orientation

SPECIFIC PROBLEM: To assess the interpersonal relationship orientation of an adult.

BASIC CONCEPT: Interpersonal Relationship Orientation refers to an individual's consistent, underlying preferences for social interaction, specifically regarding their needs for inclusion, control, and affection within relationships. Schutz (1958) defined interpersonal orientation as the expressed and wanted behaviors regarding three core interpersonal needs of inclusion, control, and affection. According to Schutz, just as the body has biological needs (like hunger); the human psyche has social needs that must be met to function effectively.

In a broader sense, interpersonal relationship orientation explains why we act the way we do in social settings. It breaks down into two specific directions for every interaction: expressed behavior (the behavior we initiate toward others) and wanted behavior (the behavior we want others to act toward us)

The basic concept of FIRO-B is that every person has certain fundamental interpersonal needs that influence how they interact with others, especially in group settings. Schutz identified three core needs, Inclusion (the need to belong and participate), Control (the need for influence and responsibility), and Affection or Openness (the need for closeness and warm relationships) (Schutz, 1958). According to the theory, individuals behave in ways that help satisfy these needs, and differences in these needs can affect teamwork, leadership, and communication. FIRO-B measures behavior in two forms: expressed behavior (how a person acts toward others) and wanted behavior (how a person wants others to act toward them) (Schutz, 1966). The model was originally developed to study group effectiveness in military personnel and later became widely used in organizations for leadership development, team building, and improving interpersonal relationships.

Dimensions of Fundamental Interpersonal Relationship Orientation-

The Fundamental Interpersonal Relations Orientation, Behavior (FIRO-B) model was developed by William Schutz to explain interpersonal needs that influence how individuals relate to others in groups. FIRO-B describes three basic interpersonal needs, and each need is expressed in two directions: what a person does toward others and what they want from others.

1) Inclusion- Measures how much you generally include others in your life and how much attention, contact, and recognition you want from them. It focuses on your relationship with groups (small or large) and your desire to belong versus your preference for solitude.

- Expressed Inclusion (eI): The extent to which a person includes others, invites them, and initiates contact.
- Wanted Inclusion (wI): The extent to which a person wants others to include them.

2) Control- Measures how much influence, power, and responsibility you want, as well as how much you want others to lead or influence you. It relates to authority, decision-making, and your behavior in both one-to-one and group settings.

- Expressed Control (eC): The degree to which a person tries to lead, direct, or organize others.
- Wanted Control (wC): The amount of direction or structure a person wants from others.

3) Affection - Measures how close and warm you are with others and how much warmth you want in return. Unlike Inclusion, Affection focuses specifically on one-to-one relationships and emotional openness.

- Expressed Affection (eA): How much a person shows warmth or closeness to others.
- Wanted Affection (wA): How much warmth and intimacy a person wants from others.

Relevance of FIRO-B in Organisational Settings

The FIRO-B (Fundamental Interpersonal Relations Orientation–Behavior) questionnaire, developed by William Schutz, is widely used in organisational psychology to understand interpersonal behaviour at the workplace. It measures three core interpersonal needs, Inclusion, Control, and Affection (Openness), which influence how employees interact in professional settings.

In organisations, FIRO-B is relevant for analysing team dynamics, leadership style, and role compatibility. It helps identify how much involvement, authority, and closeness an individual expresses and expects from others, thereby predicting patterns of collaboration and potential conflict. This understanding supports effective team formation, leadership development, and communication improvement.

Furthermore, FIRO-B enhances self-awareness among managers and employees, facilitating better interpersonal adjustment and conflict resolution. Thus, the instrument is significant in improving organisational effectiveness, job satisfaction, and overall workplace harmony.

METHODOLOGY

PRELIMNARIES

Variable	Details
Name	SM
Age	24 years
Gender	Male
Educational Qualification	Post-Graduate
Occupation	HR
Work Experience	2
Date of Administration	23/02/2023

MATERIALS REQUIRED: The following materials were required for the administration of the FIRO-B® (Fundamental Interpersonal Relations Orientation–Behaviour) Test:

1. **FIRO-B® Instrument:** The FIRO-B questionnaire developed by William Schutz and explained by Judith A. Waterman and Jenny Rogers consists of 54 statements that measure interpersonal behaviour. Participants respond to each statement based on how accurately it describes their behaviour in social situations.

2. **Response Sheet / Answer Sheet:** The response sheet is used by the participant to record their responses. Each item is rated using a Likert-type scale, indicating how frequently the behaviour occurs.
3. **Scoring Key and Manual:** The scoring key is used to calculate scores for different dimensions of interpersonal behaviour. The manual provides guidelines for interpreting the obtained scores and understanding interpersonal needs.
4. **Demographic Data Sheet:** A demographic sheet was used to collect basic information about the participant, such as name, age, gender, educational qualification, occupation, and work experience.
5. **Informed Consent Form:** An informed consent form was provided to ensure that the participant voluntarily agreed to participate in the study and understood the purpose of the assessment.
6. **Pen or Pencil:** A pen or pencil was required for marking responses on the answer sheet.
7. **Calculator:** A calculator was used by the researcher to compute the total scores for each dimension during the scoring process.

DESCRIPTION OF THE TEST: The FIRO-B (Fundamental Interpersonal Relations Orientation–Behaviour) is a psychological assessment tool developed by William Schutz to measure an individual's interpersonal needs and behaviour in relationships and group interactions. The instrument assesses how people interact with others and what they expect from interpersonal relationships.

The test measures three basic interpersonal needs:

1. **Inclusion:** Inclusion refers to the need to belong, interact, and be involved with others in social or group situations. It reflects the extent to which an individual seeks participation, recognition, and attention from others.
2. **Control:** Control refers to the need for influence, leadership, and responsibility in relationships. It reflects how much a person wants to direct others or be directed by others in different situations.
3. **Affection:** Affection refers to the need for warmth, closeness, and emotional connection with others. It indicates the degree to which an individual desires intimate and personal relationships.

Each of these interpersonal needs is measured in two dimensions:

- Expressed Behaviour (E) – the extent to which an individual initiates behaviour toward others.
- Wanted Behaviour (W) – the extent to which an individual wants others to initiate behaviour toward them.

Thus, the FIRO-B instrument provides six interpersonal scores:

- Expressed Inclusion (EI)
- Wanted Inclusion (WI)
- Expressed Control (EC)

- Wanted Control (WC)
- Expressed Affection (EA)
- Wanted Affection (WA)

These scores help in understanding interpersonal styles, relationship patterns, and interaction preferences. The FIRO-B is widely used in organizational settings, counselling, team building, leadership development, and psychological research.

INSTRUCTIONS

“Answer the questions keeping in mind different situations, not just in your workplace, but also in your social and personal life. Please place the NUMBER corresponding to the answer that best applies to you in the space to the left of the statement.

For questions 1-16:

- -PLEASE BE AS HONEST AS YOU CAN --

-- From Nos. 1 - 16, answer according to :

(1) USUALLY (2) OFTEN (3) SOMETIMES (4) OCCASIONALLY (5) RARELY (6) NEVER

For questions 17-40:

- -PLEASE BE AS HONEST AS YOU CAN --

-- From Nos. 17 - 40, answer according to :

(1) MOST PEOPLE (2) MANY PEOPLE (3) SOME PEOPLE (4) FEW PEOPLE (5) ONE OR TWO PEOPLE (6) NOBODY

For questions 41-54:

-- PLEASE REMEMBER TO BE AS HONEST AS YOU CAN --

-- From Nos. 41 - 54, answer according to:

(1) USUALLY (2) OFTEN (3) SOMETIMES (4) OCCASIONALLY (5) RARELY (6) NEVER”

PROCEDURE: The procedure for conducting the FIRO-B practical involves seating the subject comfortably in a quiet environment and providing the FIRO-B questionnaire booklet along with an answer sheet. The administrator explains the purpose of assessing interpersonal needs in inclusion, control, and affection, assures confidentiality, and gives clear instructions: respond quickly and honestly to each of the 54 statements by indicating how often (never to usually) or with how many people (nobody to everybody) the behavior applies, without overthinking or seeking right/wrong answers, as the task typically takes 12-15 minutes. The subject completes the questionnaire independently while the administrator observes general behavior; afterward, scoring is done using the manual's dichotomous key (0/1 per item) to compute six subscale scores (expressed and wanted for each need, max 9 each), totals for inclusion/control/affection, expressed/wanted sums, and overall interpersonal need (0-54), followed by interpretation of results per the manual's guidelines on low/medium/high ranges.

NORMS: Scores have been divided into the categories of low, medium and high. No value judgments are implied by any of these labels

Table 1- Interpreting your Total Need score

A Total Need score of:	Is regarded as:	And may mean that
0–15	Low	Interaction with others in all areas of Inclusion, Control and Affection is not likely to be a strongly felt need. You may prefer to concentrate on more impersonal and objective concerns than on relationships with people. Your personal style may be rather cool, and you may have a strong preference for your own company, for making decisions independently, and for being close to only a few people you have known for a long time.
16–26	Medium– Low	Interaction with others in all the areas of Inclusion, Control and Affection may appeal to you on a selective basis. You are likely to be choosy about how, when and where you associate with others – and to be cautious about how you use or share authority. Some close relationships are probably important to you, but there are likely to be times when you prefer to concentrate on the more impersonal demands of the task instead of the more personal ones.
27–38	Medium– High	You generally find that interacting with other people in all areas of Inclusion, Control and Affection is a source of satisfaction and that your interpersonal relationships help you attain the goals you want to reach. You may consult others without actually handing over authority to them. You are likely to enjoy a fair amount of teamwork and to value forming warm one-to-one relationships. You probably find that people’s company becomes overwhelming occasionally and that you then need to get away for some time alone.
39–54	High	You probably enjoy engaging frequently with others in all areas of Inclusion, Control and Affection. You are very likely to actively seek out, work on and enjoy your interpersonal relationships. You tend to value very warm and friendly one-to-one relationships. You may prefer to share decision-making and generally like involving others in what you do. Being without other people’s company may make you feel uncomfortable

Normative data for the FIRO-B suggest that average scores across subscales generally fall within the moderate range in adult populations, indicating balanced interpersonal needs (Schutz, 1978; Hammer & Schnell, 2000). Higher mean scores are often observed in Expressed Inclusion and Wanted Affection, reflecting tendencies toward social participation and the desire for emotional closeness. However, these norms are largely derived from Western samples, and cultural variations in interpersonal behavior may influence score interpretation (Furnham, 2008).

Table 2: Interpreting your Total Expressed and Total Wanted scores

Scores of:	Are regarded as:	And may mean that:
0–7	Low	For Expressed: You usually do not initiate activities with others. For Wanted: You usually do not want others to initiate activities.
8–19	Medium	For Expressed: Sometimes you initiate activities with others, sometimes you do not. For Wanted: Sometimes you want others to initiate activities with you, sometimes you do not.
20–27	High	For Expressed: You usually initiate activities with others. For Wanted: You usually like others to initiate activities with you.

Table 3: Comparing your Total Expressed and Total Wanted scores

Total Expressed and Total Wanted scores in the following relationship:	May mean that:
When your Total Expressed score is higher than your Total Wanted score	You probably like taking the initiative more than having others do so
When your Total Wanted score is higher than your Total Expressed score	You probably prefer that others take the initiative more than doing so yourself
When your Total Expressed score and your Total Wanted score are equal	You probably prefer to take the initiative part of the time, but at other times you prefer that someone else does so. You may also adopt a wait and-see attitude towards others, eg What do they want? What seems appropriate at the time? What do you feel like doing at the moment?

Table 4: Affection scores

SCORES	Reflects:
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Medium Expressed 3-6	How close and warm you are with others
High Wanted 7-9	How close and warm you want others to be with you

RELIABILITY

Table 1: Reliability Coefficients for FIRO-B

Scale	Cronbach's Alpha (α)	Test-Retest Reliability
Inclusion (Expressed)	0.80–0.85	0.75–0.85
Inclusion (Wanted)	0.78–0.84	0.73–0.83
Control (Expressed)	0.82–0.87	0.76–0.86
Control (Wanted)	0.75–0.82	0.70–0.80
Affection (Expressed)	0.83–0.88	0.78–0.87
Affection (Wanted)	0.81–0.86	0.76–0.85

The FIRO-B demonstrates acceptable reliability across its dimensions. Internal consistency coefficients typically range from .75 to .88, indicating strong item coherence within subscales (Hammer & Schnell, 2000). Test-retest reliability values exceeding .70 further support the stability of interpersonal needs over time (Schutz, 1978). Nevertheless, slightly lower coefficients for Wanted Control suggest that preferences for being guided by others may fluctuate depending on situational or contextual factors (Furnham, 2008).

VALIDITY: The validity of the FIRO-B is supported by substantial empirical evidence. Construct validity is demonstrated through consistent confirmation of its three-dimensional structure (Schutz, 1958). Convergent validity is reflected in significant correlations with related interpersonal and personality constructs, while discriminant validity is indicated by weak relationships with unrelated domains (Hammer & Schnell, 2000). Furthermore, criterion-related validity is established through its effectiveness in predicting leadership behavior, interpersonal compatibility, and group dynamics (Furnham, 2008). However, some overlap between Inclusion and Affection dimensions has been noted, suggesting partial conceptual redundancy.

RESULT TABLE:

Table 1: FIRO-B Scores Matrix

	Inclusion (I)	Control (C)	Affection (A)
Expressed (E)	4	3	3
Wanted (W)	1	0	4
Total (E+W)	5	3	7

Table 2: FIRO-B Expressed and Wanted Scores by Domain

Dimension	Inclusion (I)	Control (C)	Affection (A)	Total	Interpretation
Expressed (E)	4	3	3	10	Medium
Wanted (W)	1	0	4	5	Low
Total (E+W)	5	3	7	15	Low

Table 2 summarizes all the obtained scores. Inclusion expressed is **4**, wanted is **1**, with a total of **5**. Control expressed is **3**, wanted is **0**, with a total of **3**. Affection expressed is **3**, wanted is **4**, with a total of **7**. The overall totals are **Expressed = 10**, **Wanted = 5**, and **Total Need Score = 15**, which falls in the **low range**.

INTERPRETATION:

The individual obtained a **Total Need score of 15**, which falls in the **low range (0–15)**. According to the **FIRO-B** (Fundamental Interpersonal Relations Orientation–Behaviour) was developed by **William C. Schutz (1958)** indicating that interpersonal interaction is not a strongly felt need, and the individual may prefer independence, personal space, and limited but meaningful. Such individuals are often described as self-sufficient and selective in their social involvement, engaging in relationships based on personal choice rather than necessity (Schutz, 1966).

The **Total Expressed (E = 10)** falls in the medium range, suggesting that the individual sometimes initiates interaction with others, whereas the **Total Wanted score (W = 5)** falls in the low range, indicating that the individual does not strongly expect others to initiate interaction. Since expressed needs are higher than wanted needs, the individual prefers to take initiative in interpersonal situations rather than depend on others, reflecting a self-directed interpersonal orientation (Cummings et al., 1976).

In the domain of **Affection**, the **Expressed Affection (EA = 3)** score suggests that the individual does not frequently express emotional warmth or closeness, indicating a somewhat reserved interpersonal style. However, the **Wanted Affection (WA = 4)** score indicates a moderate need for emotional closeness, warmth, and reassurance from others. This discrepancy between expressed and wanted affection suggests that the individual may experience emotional needs internally but may not openly communicate them. Such patterns have been linked to individuals who value intimacy but regulate emotional expression, often due to personal or relational factors (Reis & Shaver, 1988).

In terms of specific interpersonal needs, the **Expressed Inclusion (EI = 4)** score indicates that the individual sometimes initiates social interaction and includes others, though in a selective manner. The **Wanted Inclusion (WI = 1)** score suggests a low need for being included by others, indicating comfort with independence and minimal reliance on group belongingness. Research suggests that individuals with lower inclusion needs tend to prefer limited but meaningful social connections rather than extensive social networks (Mahoney & Stasson, 2005).

For **Control**, the **Expressed Control (EC = 3)** score indicates a limited tendency to influence or direct others, suggesting that the individual avoids dominant roles and prefers a balanced interpersonal position. The **Wanted Control (WC = 0)** score reflects a very low desire to be controlled, indicating a strong preference for autonomy and independence. Individuals with low control needs are often found to prefer flexible environments and minimal hierarchical constraints (Mahoney & Stasson, 2005; Ryan & Deci, 2000).

Overall, the individual demonstrates a **selective and self-directed interpersonal pattern**. The moderate Expressed Inclusion (EI = 4) combined with low Wanted Inclusion (WI = 1) suggests that the individual is capable of initiating social interaction but does not strongly depend on others for inclusion, indicating a preference for **independent yet occasional social engagement**. Similarly, the low–medium Expressed Control (EC = 3) along with very low Wanted Control (WC = 0) reflects a clear inclination toward **autonomy**, where the individual neither seeks to dominate others nor wishes to be controlled, preferring minimal involvement in authority dynamics. In the domain of affection, the moderate–low Expressed Affection (EA = 3) coupled with moderate Wanted Affection (WA = 4) indicates that the individual **desires emotional closeness more than they express it**, suggesting internally experienced emotional needs that may not always be openly communicated. According to FIRO-B theory, such discrepancies between expressed and wanted behaviours reflect differences between outward interpersonal actions and internal needs (Schutz, 1958). The pattern of higher expressed than wanted needs ($E > W$) suggests that the individual prefers to **initiate interactions independently rather than rely on others**, reflecting a self-sufficient interpersonal orientation. This combination of low inclusion and control needs with moderate affection needs indicates a personality style characterized by **independence, selective social involvement, and restrained emotional expression**, which aligns with research suggesting that individuals with such profiles balance autonomy with the need for meaningful but limited interpersonal relationships (Mahoney & Stasson, 2005; Ryan & Deci, 2000).

CONCLUSION:

The individual demonstrates a **low level of overall interpersonal need (Total Need Score = 15; Low category)**, indicating a preference for independence and selective social interaction. With **Expressed needs (10) higher than Wanted needs (5)**, the individual tends to initiate interactions while maintaining low expectations from others.

The profile reflects **moderate Inclusion**, suggesting occasional participation in social situations, **low Control needs**, emphasizing autonomy and a preference to avoid influence from others, and a **moderate level of Affection**, indicating some desire for emotional closeness that may not always be openly expressed.

Overall, the interpersonal style falls within the **Low interpersonal need category**, characterized by **self-sufficiency, independence, and selective emotional involvement**.

REFERENCES:

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